

Backup options

The fifth column in fstab is the dump. It is used as a backup utility. It checks the file and gives it a number. Based on the number, it decides whether the filesystem should have a backup. If the number is 0, then the dump will ignore the file, and no backup is created for it. If you look at the fstab, the fifth volume is mainly 0.

Fsck option

The sixth column in fstab is the fsck option. Fsck helps in checking the utility of the filesystem. Fsck works according to the number present. It looks for the number in the 6th column and decides how the files will be checked. If the number on the sixth column is 0, fsck will not match the filesystem.

Field 1	Field 2	Field 3	Field 4	Field 5	Field 6
/dev/hda2	/	reiserfs	acl,user_xattr	1	1
/dev/hda1	swap	swap	defaults	0	0
proc	/proc	proc	defaults	0	0
sysfs	/sys	sysfs	noauto	0	0
debugfs	/sys/kernel/debug	debugfs	noauto	0	0
usbfs	/proc/bus/usb	usbfs	noauto	0	0
devpts	/dev/pts	devpts	mode=0620,gid=5	0	0
/dev/fd0	/media/floppy	auto	noauto,user,sync	0	0

The fstab file structure

Copyright attribute: <https://www.thegeekdiary.com/understanding-the-configuration-file-for-mounting-file-systems-etc-fstab/>

File System Examples

To simplify the concept of fstab, here are a few examples. These examples will help you understand the different file systems types. Here, we have used /dev/sdb1 or /dev/hda2 to make this concept easy to understand. But remember that any /dev location, UUID=<some_id>, or LABEL=<some_label> can work.

Extended file systems (ext)

There are three types of ext filesystems. These are ext2, ext3, and ext4. Ext3 is more advanced than ext2. The difference between ext2 and ext3 is journaling. Ext3 helps to protect the files when the device crashes. Ext4 is more advanced and modern in terms of protection than ext3.

- **A root filesystem, use the command**
 - `UUID=30fcb748-ad1e-4228-af2f-951e8e7b56df / ext3 defaults,errors=remount-ro,noatime 0 1`
- **A non-root file system ext2, run the command**
 - `/dev/sdb1 /media/disk2 ext2 defaults 0 2`